

Run Out

MAY 3, 2010

As one of the world's most powerful sports impresarios faces the ignominy of being booted out, his own story of delusion and hubris merges with the larger narrative of an unholy alliance of cricket, politics and big business.



“The entire IPL episode, including the resignation of Shashi Tharoor and the suspension of Lalit Modi, is sordid. It is clear that various factions are fighting each other ruthlessly to avenge personal slights.”

RAJENDRA K. ANEJA, *Dubai*

Pitch Black

IPL Commissioner Lalit Modi would have never imagined that the IPL would turn into such a mega money-making machine in such a short span of time (“Run Out”, May 3). Nor would he have imagined that his giving out details of the Rendezvous Sports consortium, the franchisee of the Kochi team, on Twitter would start a fire which would engulf him too. In a way, it is good that the controversy has turned the spotlight on the funding of the IPL and all its teams. The affairs of such a high-value venture must be absolutely transparent. **PADMINI RAGHAVENDRA, Secunderabad**

Did no one in the BCCI have any clue about the running of the IPL cash cow for the



KRISHNA MURARI KISHAN

Barbaric Practice

The practice of punishing, at times even killing, men and women suspected of witchcraft is atrocious (“Medieval Fever”, May 3). It is one more example of indignities inflicted on helpless people in the guise of religion and worship. Nevertheless, strict legal action and social awareness can dent it.

Y.G. CHOUKSEY, Pune

Illiteracy is the root of all evils, and is advantageously misused by unscrupulous witch doctors to acquire money and social honour. The number of cases on record may just be the tip of the iceberg. It is symptomatic of the failure of the administrative system, especially of the police. It also makes the probity of the local representatives questionable and points to their complicity in promoting superstitions.

INDU SHANKAR, Varanasi

last three years? If Modi is likely to be guilty on many counts, the pitiful fossils in the BCCI must be guilty too. At least Modi single-handedly created the IPL brand and could even take it to South Africa. Suspiciously, no government agency was worried about its legality when the unholy BCCI-IPL deals were struck, or ‘facilitation fees’ charged, allegedly by Modi unilaterally. And now, all of a sudden, they’re raiding everywhere.

VINOD KUMAR B., Bangalore

It is strange that the Government chose to act against Modi only when he had exposed the blatant acts of corruption perpetrated by one of its own, namely Shashi Tharoor. If it is so concerned about cleaning up the murky dealings in the IPL, what

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